To be on the safe side, however, when I called her, I said: “I have an early call in the morning, so I’m afraid we’ll have to make it an early evening.”

“Fine,” Nancy said, “I’ve got an early call, too. I can’t stay out too late either.”

She had her pride, too.

We were both lying.

When I picked her up that evening at her apartment, I was standing on two canes a la Pete MacArthur: Several months earlier I’d shattered my right thighbone during a charity softball game and was still hobbling around because of it.

I took her to a restaurant on the Sunset Strip and soon realized that Mervyn hadn’t been exaggerating when he’d said she was really steamed up over having been confused with someone else.

Well, I suggested, one solution would be to change her name—actresses did it all the time, I said.

When I said that, Nancy looked at me with her hazel eyes and a sense of logic that made me feel a little ridiculous: *“But Nancy Davis is my name,”* she said.

Pretty soon, we weren’t talking any more about her problem, but about her mother, who had been a Broadway actress, and her father, a prominent surgeon, and our lives in general. Although we’d agreed to call it an early night, I didn’t want the evening to end, so I said: “Have you ever seen Sophie Tucker? She’s singing at Ciro’s just down the street. Why don’t we go see the first show?”

Well, she’d never heard Sophie Tucker before so we went to Ciro’s to catch the first show. Then we stayed for the second show and we got home about three o’clock in the morning. No mention was made of early calls. I invited her to dinner the following night and we went to the Malibu Inn.

After that, we dated occasionally, sometimes with our good friends, Bill and Ardis Holden, but both of us continued